

Fans to Get Preview Of Sun Kings

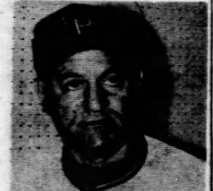
El Paso baseball fans will only get a quick preview of the 1966 edition of their ball club before the Sun Kings take off on a six-game road tour.

That quick preview will be at Dudley Field this Sunday and Monday in a two game series with the Albuquerque Dodgers which opens the season here.

Game time Sunday is 2:27 p.m. and on Monday it will be 7:27 p.m.

Following this opening series the Kings will go on the road to play three games against the Amarillo Sonics, and another three against the Dallas-Fort Worth Spurs.

They will return to Dudley Field on Monday, April 25th to play a four game series with the Austin Braves. The homestand will finish up with three games against the Sonics.



BACK ON THE LINE — Sun King coach Andy Cohen will be back in action this season working the first base coaching spot. Andy was ready to hang up the spikes until the California Angels prevailed on him to go another season. As player, coach, and manager he has put in over 40 years in organized baseball.



PRIME PROSPECTS—The Sun Kings walked away with two of the prime prospects in the California Angel farm system following spring training at Holtville, Calif. First baseman Jim Spencer, left, won the Dick Wantz trophy which goes to the player who shows the most dedication and improvement in spring training. King second baseman Tom Sommers, on the right, was runner-up. Making the presentation is Roland Hemond director of the farm system.

There Has Been a Shake-Up Of Texas League Managers

There has been a general shake-up among managers in the Texas League this season.

Chuck Tanner of El Paso and Vern Rapp of the Arkansas Travelers are the veterans, and they are just beginning their second season.

UP ALBUQUERQUE way former major leaguer Bob Kennedy will be the manager. He is the youngest of the six managers at 35.

Bob Kennedy started as player with the White Sox in 1939 and spent the next 17 years in the American League with the exception of three years for military service.

In 1957 he moved to the Dodgers in the National League, and since 1962 he has been with the Chicago Cubs as a coach and manager.

THIS YEAR he is back with the Dodgers and piloting their Class AA ball club.

In the panhandle the Houston Astros have put Buddy Hackett in charge of the Amarillo Sonics. A former catcher and manager,

Hackett also did some scouting for the Pirates before retiring from baseball to run his successful insurance business in Beaumont. Houston is bringing him back this season after being out of baseball in 1965.

A new manager with the most interesting name in the Texas League is Hub Kittle who will manage the Braves at Austin.

KITTLE is highly prized in the Atlanta Braves organization as a fine developer of young talent. He has handled farm teams for the past 12 years and he has finished out of the money only three times. He also won four pennants.

The fourth new face belongs to a well-known and illustrious name in baseball, Stan Hack.

THE OLDEST manager in the league at 56, Stan Hack had 16 years of outstanding service at third base with the Chicago Cubs, including the novelty of playing on their last pennant winning team.

Stan Hack will be piloting the Cub entry at Dallas-Fort Worth. He can draw on 14 years experience as a manager.



IT STARTS FROM HERE—This will be the second season that the Sun Kings have been hooked up with the California Angels in a full working agreement. Sitting in for the formal signing are, from left to right seated, Gene Autry, chairman of the board for the Angels, general manager Fred Hasey, and King president John Phelan. Standing from left to right are Marvin Milkes, assistant manager, and Roland Hemond, director of the farm system.

'Inside' People Help Make Club Operate Smoothly

While the baseball stars are out on the field there is always a small group of dedicated "inside" people who help make the operation of the El Paso baseball club possible.

The two veterans of the business staff who have been with the ball club since it began operation in 1961 are comptroller Bob Redmond, and Earl Hardage.

BOTH RETIRED businessmen, they donate many hours of their time during the season to help keep the ball club running.

Another key figure in the Sun

King operation is trainer Pete Luther, back for his second season. An avid photographer, many times he doesn't know whether to grab the limelight or his camera in a real action ball game.

Luther presides over baseball's wailing wall, the training room. It's his job to keep the players patched up and in the game.

A NEW addition to the staff this year is Ray Whitworth who will do all of the ball club's radio broadcasts, and who will also be assisting with many of the club's big promotions for the fans.

Also new to the Sun King family this season is office secretary Rose Marie Nabours who has had to become a sports fan in self defense.

Arkansas Team Added To League

There has been one change in the Texas League, this season with the addition of the Arkansas Travelers from Little Rock who are new in the League.

The Travelers should be an interesting addition to the league and they should also be a contending team after being well stocked by the St. Louis Cardinals.

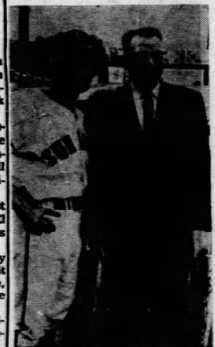
Little Rock will make its first appearance of the season in El Paso on May 17th. Vern Rapp is their manager.

Otherwise the line-up is pretty much as local fans have known it with the Dodgers in Albuquerque, the Sonics in Amarillo, and the Braves in Austin.

The always tough Spur in Dallas-Fort Worth complete the line-up this year.

Albuquerque, Austin, and Amarillo are all owned outright by their parent clubs while the other three ball clubs have full working agreements.

El Paso will be the lone American League entry in the Texas League due to its affiliation with the California Angels.



FRONT OFFICE AND FIELD — Sun King manager Chuck Tanner, and King president John Phelan got together at Dudley Field to talk over strategy before the opening game of the season here on Sunday. (Photograph by Photography Unlimited.)

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